

Quintessential Latin

Proposal for registration in the Under-ConScript Unicode Registry

Draft proposal · 6 September 2026 · Reference font 0.250

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1. Purpose and scope

Quintessential Latin is a systematic repertoire of Latin-derived letterforms. It combines uprights, shoulders, hips, legs, arms, bowls, and spines into 1,216 named constructions. The repertoire is independent of any particular language or pronunciation system.

This document proposes coordinated private-use assignments for the complete current repertoire in the Under-ConScript Unicode Registry (UCSUR). The assignments provide a stable way to exchange the constructions as text. This is a draft for review, not an announcement of registration or inclusion in the Unicode Standard.

The proposal concerns construction identities and their interchange. It does not prescribe readings for every form or claim that every structural distinction has already been accepted as an independently encodable character.

2. Proposed allocation

The requested space comprises three consecutive blocks spanning exactly 1,216 positions in Supplementary Private Use Area-A, U+F2A00-U+F2EBF. Every position is assigned. Construction families and all their middle-extension states occupy consecutive positions without reserved holes or a separate additions area.

The UCSUR roadmap shows no listed allocation at U+F2A00-U+F2EBF when checked on 6 September 2026. This indicates apparent availability in that table; it establishes no reservation and does not exclude private use elsewhere.

- Quintessential Latin: U+F2A00-U+F2ABF; 192 characters.
- Quintessential Latin Extended-A: U+F2AC0-U+F2BBF; 256 characters.
- Quintessential Latin Extended-B: U+F2BC0-U+F2EBF; 768 characters.
- Extended-A begins with double bowl, double open bowl, turned double open bowl, and spine. The main block begins with bowl, open bowl, and turned open bowl.

3. Construction principles

A construction is described from left to right. An upright has independently specified upper and lower endings. Short, straight-extended, and curved endings yield the nine primitive names stem, ascender, hook, descender, long stem, long hook, tail, long tail, and long spine.

A shoulder is an upper branch and a hip is its lower counterpart. A leg includes its upper connecting arch; an arm includes its lower connecting arch. Bowls, double bowls, and spines join these components into wider forms.

Long bowls distinguish open returns from returns closed by an immediately adjacent upright. Naming records local closure, not a remote feature elsewhere in the construction. Repeated arches and extended middle components form systematic companion families. Where two middle legs or arms occur, each can extend independently: neither, left only, right only, or both. Left and right refer to the final visible form, including reversed constructions.

The seven stemless forms are bowl, open bowl, turned open bowl, double bowl, double open bowl, turned double open bowl, and spine. The three simple bowls begin the main block; the four double-bowl and spine forms begin Extended-A. Their presence does not assign them digit or punctuation values.

4. Character identity and composition

Each allocated construction is represented by one Unicode scalar value in the proposed private-use map. The component vocabulary describes its visible structure; it is not a sequence of separately encoded combining marks.

Concatenating primitive character codes does not request automatic formation of a compound construction. Compounds already in the repertoire have their own explicit assignments. No decomposition or normalization equivalence between these codes is specified.

Opposite-facing forms have distinct assignments where the repertoire includes them. Roman and Italic are typographic postures of the same mapped construction. Font weight and posture never change its stored code point.

All 1,216 constructions, including the seven stemless forms, are lowercase letters. Their full names use SMALL LETTER to record this case. Uppercase typography in the charts is a documentation convention; no uppercase counterparts or uppercase mappings are defined.

Version 0.250 replaces the earlier private-use map. Existing construction identities and native outlines are retained, but their numeric assignments are reorganized. No aliases or backward compatibility with earlier numeric assignments are provided.

5. Names and ordering

The current canonical naming system is version 3. The first two component terms are joined by “with”; subsequent terms are joined by “and”. Interior uprights use the ordinary stem, ascender, and descender names. Local bowl closure and counts of equal adjacent uprights are resolved before names are serialized.

Names are unique across the 1,216-entry repertoire. Every chart name, including the seven stemless forms, is the uppercase construction name prefixed by QUINTESSENTIAL LATIN SMALL LETTER. The structural construction-name algorithm remains version 3; this prefix clarifies the lowercase identity of the existing repertoire.

Code charts, names lists, and presentation order follow the same numeric construction order across 30 families. Middle-extension companions remain inside their base family: a single middle component has short and extended states; two middle components have neither, left-only, right-only, and both-extended states together. Code values, stable identities, and internal font glyph names remain distinct.

6. Reference text behavior

The reference implementation presents text horizontally from left to right. Every allocated form is a spacing character in the font, with its own advance. The font includes U+0020 SPACE and kerning between reference glyphs.

All proposed characters have the private-use interpretation `General_Category=Ll` (`Lowercase_Letter`). No uppercase or titlecase counterparts or mappings, non-identity case-folding mappings, special word-breaking rules, or combining behavior are proposed. There is no separately specified punctuation or numeral system.

Standard Unicode implementations continue to give these private-use code points `General_Category=Co`. The accompanying UCD-style files propose Ll only for cooperating applications that explicitly adopt this private-use agreement; they do not install normative Unicode properties or normalization mappings.

Applications must preserve supplementary-plane scalar values. In UTF-16, a mapped character occupies a surrogate pair; editing and copying must keep that pair intact.

7. Reference implementation

Quintessential Serif 0.250 is the reference typeface. It provides all 1,216 mapped constructions in both Roman and native Italic. The two variable fonts support a continuous weight range from 400 to 700 and retain the reference design's nonlinear weight mapping.

All allocated characters have native Italic outlines. The two postures use their own STIX Two Text donors and compatible endpoint masters; the website does not synthesize an Italic face.

Variable TTF and WOFF2 fonts and four static endpoint faces are supplied with editable UFO sources, designspaces, build tools, and regression fixtures. The reference fonts derive from the pinned STIX Two Text 2.13 b171 donors and retain the SIL Open Font License.

Font development and character registration are separate processes. The reference design remains a work in progress; a rendered sample is not a prescribed exclusive glyph shape.

8. Accompanying charts and data

Each block has a reference PDF containing a title/range page, code grids, and a numeric names list. A combined catalogue contains all three blocks. Five grid sheets show up to 256 positions each: the main block has 12 hexadecimal columns, and the other four sheets have 16. Every grid stops exactly at its block boundary.

Reference PDFs use Quintessential Serif 0.250, Roman 400. Each assigned position shows its representative glyph and hexadecimal code. The current allocation is gapless; no unassigned positions are shown.

The downloadable allocation, compact browser catalogue, and names lists are generated from one explicit source. Character names and code points agree across the PDFs, website, font mappings, and machine-readable downloads. The accompanying UCD-style package includes `UnicodeData`, `Blocks`, `NamesList`, `CaseFolding`, `Charts`, and `Sources` files, with lowercase classification, undefined uppercase mappings, and identity case folding.

9. Matters for registry review

The suitability of each construction distinction for separate registration remains open to review. This proposal intentionally records the complete implemented inventory so that reviewers can assess the distinctions against consistent names, reference glyphs, and a working interchange map.

Readings, handwriting conventions, language-specific spelling systems, and any future punctuation or numeral assignments are outside the current proposal. No broad user community, historical tradition, or accepted registry status is asserted.

Future repertoire changes must identify additions, removals, or reassignments explicitly. A font design change alone does not create a new character.

10. Availability and contact

The project source, reference fonts, chart PDFs, and proposal are available from the public Quintessential Latin repository and website. Corrections and technical discussion can be submitted through GitHub Issues.

Author: Josh Hufford. Repository: <https://github.com/ostomachion/quintessential-latin>. Website: <https://ostomachion.github.io/quintessential-latin/>. Contact: <https://github.com/ostomachion/quintessential-latin/issues>.

11. Revision history

6 September 2026: initial standalone draft, preserving the 0.220 reference fonts and naming version 2. Introduces the general block titles Quintessential Latin, Quintessential Latin Extended-A, and Quintessential Latin Extended-B without changing character codes or identities.

6 September 2026: naming version 3 gives every character the QUINTESSENTIAL LATIN LETTER prefix, uses ordinary upright names for interior components, and combines equal adjacent uprights into counts. Code points, construction identities, and the 0.220 reference fonts are unchanged.

6 September 2026: reference font and allocation version 0.240 add 384 constructions with independently extended middle components at U+F2E00-U+F2F7F. All preceding 832 identities and assignments are retained. Both native postures support the complete 1,216-character repertoire; canonical naming remains version 3.

6 September 2026: reference font and allocation version 0.250 organize all 1,216 constructions into a continuous U+F2A00-U+F2EBF map and 30 families. Middle-extension states are integrated with their bases, and the four stemless double-bowl and spine forms begin Extended-A. This replaces the earlier numeric assignments without compatibility aliases; the repertoire and native glyph designs are unchanged.

6 September 2026: the author clarifies that all 1,216 constructions are lowercase letters. Full names adopt the QUINTESSENTIAL LATIN SMALL LETTER prefix and the private-use UCD interpretation changes from Lo to Ll. Uppercase and titlecase counterparts and mappings remain undefined; case folding is identity. Construction names and naming algorithm version 3, code points, block ranges, font designs, and allocation version 0.250 are unchanged. Any future uppercase additions would require explicit assignments and mappings.

References

1. Under-ConScript Unicode Registry: allocation table: <https://www.kreativekorp.com/ucsur/>
2. Under-ConScript Unicode Registry: roadmap: <https://www.kreativekorp.com/ucsur/roadmap.shtml>
3. ConScript Unicode Registry: introduction and proposal precedents: <https://www.evertype.com/standards/csur/>
4. The Unicode Standard: code chart conventions: <https://www.unicode.org/charts/About.html>
5. Unicode code chart reference: Miscellaneous Technical: <https://www.unicode.org/charts/PDF/U2300.pdf>
6. STIX Two Text 2.13 b171 source release: <https://github.com/stipub/stixfonts/releases/tag/v2.13b171>
7. SIL Open Font License 1.1: <https://openfontlicense.org/open-font-license-official-text/>